

FX Technical Update

A strong payrolls report keeps dollar strength in gear

- EUR/USD could see the near-term range broaden to test the 1.0713-1.0735 support band, but we suspect further consolidation above that area over the near term as the market builds a medium-term top pattern. Look for bounces to fade near 1.0912-1.0934. Key medium-term resistance remains in the 1.10-handles.
- The EUR/JPY bounces from the 158.39-159.01 short-term support zone. Look for continued selling pressure near 161.24-162.05 resistance as a broader top pattern develops. Short-term bears would gain material traction with a break below the 156.71 200-day moving average for another go at the 153.86-154.03 support zone. We expect a downside break and start of a bear cycle in the months ahead.
- Cable continues to carve out a potential short-term distribution pattern after the fourth-quarter rally decelerated near the 1.2726 Jul 61.8% retrace. Sustained closes below 1.2611 pattern support, 1.2526 Oct 38.2% retrace, and nearby cluster of moving averages would confirm the downside trend reversal.
- The USD/JPY bounce from 145.45-146.97 short-term support keeps the 149.442-150.80 resistance zone front and center. We look for subsequent strength to fade there again.
- AUD/USD tries to establish a short-term bullish reversal at critical support near 0.65. An inability to surpass the 0.664-0.6657 resistance zone and subsequent weakness would put the pair on course for a decline toward broader range support at 0.617-0.6296.

Technical Strategy

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EUR/USD continues to consolidate around its tightly clustered moving averages

EUR/USD spends more time consolidating in close proximity to the 50-day, 100-day, and 200-day moving averages on the heels of the slide from the **1.1142** Dec peak and reversal from near chart resistance in the **1.10**-handles (Figure 1). That keeps the pair grinding lower toward next support at the **1.0735** Dec-Jan equal swings objective, **1.0724** early-Dec low and **1.0713** Oct 61.8% retrace. We suspect the market can spend more time trading around current levels, with tactical resistance at the **1.0912** 50-day moving average and **1.0934** Jan 24 high. After the strong payrolls report and FOMC message that seemed to have pushed back the timing of the first ease into late spring, we suspect that area will cap rebounds. Other resistance remains in the **1.10**s, which we think will cap the market through the first quarter. Even if the market sees further consolidation in the weeks ahead, we seek the Nov-Feb price action as a broad distribution pattern and favor an eventual release through support near **1.07**. Look for a downside break to eventually retest broader range support at **1.0405-1.0451** and then break to longer-term levels at **1.00-1.02**. Conversely, broader range resistance rests at **1.1275-1.1292**.

Figure 1: EUR/USD could see the near-term range broaden to test the 1.0713-1.0735 support band, but we suspect further consolidation above that area over the near term as the market builds a medium-term top pattern. Look for bounces to fade near 1.0912-1.0934. Key medium-term resistance remains in the 1.10-handles.

EUR/USD, daily bars with momentum divergence signals



Source: J.P. Morgan, CQG

EUR/JPY tries to hold short-term support as the right shoulder of a broader top pattern develops

EUR/JPY stabilizes near the **158.39-159.01** short-term support zone after the slide from resistance at the **161.24** Nov 21 low and **162.05** Nov 78.6% retrace (Figure 2). We are looking for residual strength to continue to find selling pressure near that resistance, as the pair carves out the right shoulder of a broader head-and-shoulders top pattern. That pattern started to develop in 2H23 and has unfolded mostly below longer-term resistance at **162.42-164.32**. Immediate weakness through the **156.71** 200-day moving average would like see momentum pick up. Key medium-term support rests at the **154.03** Jan 2023 38.2% retrace, **153.86** Dec low, and then **151.37-151.62** chart inflection. The multi-year trend channel that defines the broader bull market sits in that same area. A downside break would confirm the longer-term bearish trend reversal.

Figure 2: The EUR/JPY bounces from the 158.39-159.01 short-term support zone. Look for continued selling pressure near 161.24-162.05 resistance as a broader top pattern develops. Short-term bears would gain material traction with a break below the 156.71 200-day moving average for another go at the 153.86-154.03 support zone. We expect a downside break and start of a bear cycle in the months ahead.

EUR/JPY, daily bars with momentum divergence signals



Source: J.P. Morgan, CQG

Cable technical setup unchanged as likely distribution pattern presses on for another week

If you read last week's update for cable or the week before for that matter, save yourself some time and move onto the next section. The range persists, and we continue to see that as a likely distribution pattern after the fourth-quarter advance decelerated as it achieved the **1.2726** Jul 61.8% retrace (Figure 3). Key short-term pattern support rests at **1.2611**. A break would seek the **1.2526** Oct 38.2% retrace and nearby cluster of moving averages. In our view, a move through that set of levels would put medium-term bears back in control as it would confirm a broader trend reversal. Next support rests at the **1.2339** Oct 61.8% retrace and Oct pattern high. While our bearish medium-term outlook for cable favors an eventual break through that support, we need to see bearish trend dynamics build after the 4Q23 rally put our view on the back foot. Bigger picture, we

expect an eventual test of support near **1.20** and then **1.16-1.18** in the months/quarters ahead. Conversely, a continued rally would seek next resistance at the **1.2915** Jul 78.6% retrace, which is followed by longer-term resistance surrounding the **1.314** Jul 2023 peak.

Figure 3: Cable continues to carve out a potential short-term distribution pattern after the fourth-quarter rally decelerated near the 1.2726 Jul 61.8% retrace. Sustained closes below 1.2611 pattern support, 1.2526 Oct 38.2% retrace, and nearby cluster of moving averages would confirm the downside trend reversal.

GBP/USD, daily bars with momentum divergence signals



Source: J.P. Morgan, CQG

USD/JPY bounces from 145.45-146.97 key short-term support

USD/JPY rebounds from key short-term support at **145.45-146.97** after a strong US payrolls report. That support includes the 50-day moving average and Jan pattern breakout area (Figure 4). Overhead resistance remains at the **149.442** Nov 78.6% retrace, **149.755** early-Dec pivot, and **150.80** Mar-Jul internal trend line, where we expect a good deal of selling pressure to contain the advance again. We think the market is setting up for a short-, medium-, and longer-term downside trend reversal. A break through the **144.62** 200-day moving average would start to give that view some teeth. We are looking for the market to bearishly pressure key medium-term support at the **139.585** Jan 2023 50% retrace and another cluster at **136.668-137.915** in the months ahead. Alternatively, longer-term resistance remains at the **151.945** 2022-2023 double top.

Figure 4: The USD/JPY bounce from 145.45-146.97 short-term support keeps the 149.442-150.80 resistance zone front and center. We look for subsequent strength to fade there again.

USD/JPY, daily bars with momentum divergence signals



Source: J.P. Morgan, CQG

AUD/USD tries to find footing near key support surrounding 0.65

AUD/USD tries to find some footing after the slide from the **0.6781-0.6901** medium-term resistance zone pressed into critical support near **0.65**. That includes the fourth-quarter base pattern highs and Oct 61.8% retrace (Figure 5). The initial attempt to turn from that support triggered a momentum divergence buy signal (green arrow), but the move faded after the strong payrolls report. Now in the middle of the broader 2023 trading range, we will watch the price action for guidance as to which end of that range the market will like move towards. Our bias is to the downside. A continued inability to trade back above the **0.6657** 50-day moving average and recent pattern breakdown would build confidence in that outlook. A break to the downside would seek the **0.64** Oct 78.6% retrace. Longer-term support sits at **0.617-0.6269**. We are looking for a retest of that area in the months ahead. Since AUD/USD and other manufacturing cycle sensitive markets have potentially front-loaded a lot of weakness, we see the prospect that those markets can outperform other risky markets in as a broader DM slowdown is priced through the year.

Figure 5: AUD/USD tries to establish a short-term bullish reversal at critical support near 0.65. An inability to surpass the 0.664-0.6657 resistance zone and subsequent weakness would put the pair on course for a decline toward broader range support at 0.617-0.6296.

AUD/USD, daily bars with momentum divergence signals



Source: J.P. Morgan, CQG

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